DAY 13

When Plans Change



"People plan their paths, but the Lord directs their steps."
PROVERBS 16:9

You had already imagined how it would be. Perhaps there was a date, a place, and people belonging to that new chapter. Then news changed everything. The plan organizing your future disappeared or needed revising. Beyond practical difficulty comes the loss of a story you had already begun living in your imagination.

Proverbs acknowledges both human planning and the limits of our control. Trust in the Lord invites us to hold plans humbly. Planning remains a responsible activity; it is not made useless. What changes is our willingness to recognize limits and seek guidance when the path requires revision.

Not every change needs an immediate spiritual explanation. Human decisions, injustice, mistakes, and circumstances we do not understand interrupt plans. Quickly declaring that everything happened to teach a lesson may prevent pain from being welcomed. You can seek God within a change without claiming to know why it happened.

You may need to grieve what was lost. An expectation can also require a farewell. Admitting disappointment helps keep you from entering the next chapter silently obliged to recover exactly what you imagined. Some things can be rebuilt; others require a different direction. You need not decide while the news is still finding its place in your heart.

When there is room to think, notice what remains. Abilities, relationships, and values have not disappeared with the plan. The timetable may change while your desire to learn remains. An opportunity may end while your experience can serve elsewhere. Recognizing these elements gives you ground for decisions without demanding immediate enthusiasm.

You can pray about what was interrupted and what is still unformed. Ask for discernment to distinguish responsible persistence from attachment to an unavailable path. Listen to trusted people and gather needed information. Direction may become clear gradually through prudent choices rather than in one moment of absolute certainty.

Change need not determine the worth of your whole story. You lived, learned, and loved within plans that may not have reached their expected outcome. That remains part of you. Another stretch lies ahead. Allow time to grieve and openness to recognize possibilities, trusting that you can seek the Lord on this unfamiliar ground too.

TO KEEP IN YOUR HEART

You can acknowledge the pain of an interrupted plan and seek direction for the path beginning now.

TODAY'S PRAYER

Lord, this change has brought disappointment and uncertainty. Receive my sadness over what I imagined and did not happen. Help me understand what I can rebuild and what I must release. Give me time to feel, clarity to gather information, and humility to seek guidance. Keep me from deciding merely to escape pain or feeling obliged to recover the past. Guide my steps in this chapter and help me recognize what remains possible. Amen.